

students are in debt. This is why it's so important to reach young people early to teach them how to make the best money decisions for themselves. As women specifically, it's easy for us to get sucked into the world of comparison and start doubting our power thanks to social media. Before they reach adulthood, young women must know who they are so they can make smart financial decisions for themselves and not based on how they are being influenced on social media. It's so sad for me to see young girls wasting money on things without acquiring any assets. The world has made it okay to have priorities mixed up. This is why college and high school girls are so important to teach financial education.

Q. You also work with a lot of mothers, specifically single mothers, on improving their personal finances and building generational wealth despite not having a dual-income household. What are some everyday tips you share to help them start investing consistently?

A. I would say to them just like you budget your bills, you should budget your investments. Look at investing as another bill that you have to pay in order to ensure the future that you desire. Your utility bills will not make you rich or help you build generational wealth. However, your investments will bring wealth in your life. Make budgeting your investments as important as your monthly bills. Oftentimes people think investing only has to do with investing in the stock market or real estate. Although those are equally important, investing in yourself is crucial. I always allocate a portion to investing in myself and for my children, whether that is investing in a coach, a seminar, or in actual stocks. Another way to allocate money to investing is to automate sending a part of your income to an investment account. You will be surprised that you can “miraculously” find the money to invest when you automate those deposits.

Q. It's also important to have the right mindset about investing; what would you say to someone just getting started?

A. I would say start where you are. Please do not think that because you do not have a lot of money, you should not invest. It is actually the total opposite; because you do not have a lot of money, you should invest so your money can grow. Start with what you have, even if that means starting with \$5. There are so many apps that you can use to start investing. Also don't